told, by strenuous attempts on the part of the British to improve its condition and to teach its people the art of self-government, is to-day, a miserable mass of poverty-stricken, starving, and dying people.

Bengal had the first full experience of British rule in India. That rule began with outright plunder, and a land revenue system which extracted the uttermost farthing not only from the living but also from the dead cultivators. The English historians of India, Edward Thompson and G. T. Garrett, tell us that 'a gold-lust unequalled since the hysteria that took hold of the Spaniards of Cortes' and Pizarro's age filled the English mind. Bengal in particular was not to know peace again until she has been bled white.' 'For the monstrous financial immorality of the English conduct in India for many a year after this, Glive was largely responsible.'* Clive, the great empire-builder, whose statue faces the India Office in London to-day. It was pure loot. The 'Pagoda tree' was shaken again and again till the most terrible famines ravaged Bengal. This process was called trade later on but that made little difference. Government was this so-called trade, and trade was plunder. There are few instances in history